

Physical Education & Gym

Year 4

Cambridge Primary

Student Manual



Physical Education

Year 4 · Student Manual The Sports Day Field

A student book for Lower Primary, written for pupils of about eight to nine years old. Year 1 played in the meadow. Year 2 played on a marked court. Year 3 worked on one measured lane, refining a single movement. This year the whole field is open, four events run at once, and you have to keep everything you can already do while other people are moving.

Six parts of one field: the Grass Lanes, the Judges' Table, the Open Field, the Team Enclosure, the Kit Marquee and the Finish Field. Pip, Bramble, Sorrel, Tuft, Willow and Rowan are all here again, a year older, and this year they are not alone on the grass.

FOUR JOBS, AND YOU WILL DO ALL OF THEM

Mover

Does the movement, properly.

Timer

Counts, and says the real number.

Watcher

Looks at one thing, and says what they saw.

Setter

Lays the ground out, and changes it.

Last year you found out how good one movement could get. This year you find out how many of them you can keep.

Physical Education • Year 4

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Safety, and it is not a formality. This is a Physical Education book, so almost every task moves a body through a space, and this year several bodies move through it at once. Every task assumes a teacher present, a space checked before the lesson, and apparatus set out and tested by an adult. The teacher carries out their own risk assessment and follows the school's safety policy. Where a task carries a particular risk, the book says so on the page in a green **Stay safe** panel. Those panels are instructions, not advice.

Inclusion. Every comparison in this book asks a pupil to look at their own earlier attempt. No task ranks one pupil against another, and no task requires a particular body to succeed. Teachers adapt distances, heights and timings freely: the objective is control, not size.

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The programme for the Grass Lanes. Four lanes, one project, and everything you need before you start.

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This edition carries Unit 1, Moving Well, at the Grass Lanes. Units 2 to 6, the Judges' Table, the Open Field, the Team Enclosure, the Kit Marquee and the Finish Field, follow in the complete book.

Your sports year

Three terms, and at the end of each one the whole year group comes out onto the field for a day. You already know what is coming, so you can practise for it.

TERM 1 16 December 2026	TERM 2 17 March 2027	TERM 3 17 June 2027
Athletics Day ● Sprint ● Relays ● Standing long jump ● Target throw ● Obstacle race <i>Unit 1 is the one that gets you ready: a relay is four movers and three joins.</i>	Football Day ● Dribbling in and out of the cones ● Passing accuracy game ● Penalty shootout ● Full game <i>A full game is topic 1.4 for ninety minutes: everybody moving at once.</i>	Multi-sports Day ● Bowling ● Sack racing ● Bean bag throw ● Water pong <i>Five different families of movement in one morning. That is your whole range, checked.</i>

Look down the three lists and count how many of those you practise in this book. The sprint, the relay, the standing long jump, the target throw and the obstacle race are **all** in Unit 1, and so is the thing that decides a football match: knowing where everybody else is going.

WHAT TO PRACTISE BEFORE EACH DAY

- 1 Before Athletics Day.** The round of eight in 1.1 has a throw, a jump, a travel and a stop in it. Those are four of the five events. For the relay, practise the three joins in 1.2 with a baton.
- 2 Before Football Day.** Topic 1.4 is the whole of it: read where somebody else is going, decide who gives way, and keep your movement when the ground changes.
- 3 Before Multi-sports Day.** Topic 1.1 again. A day of five different activities is a test of your **range**, not of any one skill.

Nothing on the three days is a surprise. That is the point of knowing the dates in August.

Welcome to the sports day field

Last year you learned the most useful thing in this whole subject: how to take one movement you could already do and make it better on purpose.

This year you are going to find out what happens when you have to do that with **everything at once**, on a field with other people on it.

Here is the difference, and it is a real one. On the Cinder Track in Year 3, one body moved at a time and two friends watched it. On the sports day field, four events run together. Somebody is throwing behind you. Somebody is coming down the next lane. The person who set out your station has just moved a cone while you were looking the other way.

None of that makes the movement harder. It makes **keeping** the movement harder, and that is the Year 4 job.



The six friends walk out. Rowan has the hoops, Bramble has the cones, Tuft has a clipboard almost as big as he is, Sorrel has the measuring tape and Pip has the baton. Willow is flying low behind them. Nobody is running yet, and everything in this book is being carried onto the field in this picture.

THE FIELD · SIX PARTS, ONE FOR EACH UNIT

- 1 **The Grass Lanes.** Keeping the whole range of movements you have, linking more of them together, making them flow, and holding all of that when other people are on the grass.
- 2 **The Judges' Table.** Willow's place. The words a judge uses, and how to measure a performance against a criterion instead of a feeling.
- 3 **The Open Field.** Finding more than one answer to the same challenge, and moving to say something.
- 4 **The Team Enclosure.** Every job in a team, the goal you set yourself, and taking a turn at leading and at following.
- 5 **The Kit Marquee.** One marquee and a whole class: sharing, settling an argument without an adult, and what fair play costs.
- 6 **The Finish Field.** What is happening inside you while you move, how hard is hard enough, and what a moving body needs.

This book is part one. The other five follow.

Four jobs, and you will do all of them

Almost every task in this book needs four people, because you cannot watch yourself move, and because somebody has to change something while you work.

JOB	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT YOU MUST NOT DO
Mover	Do the movement, properly, as many times as the task says	Rush it to look quick, or change it halfway through
Timer	Count, or time, and say the number out loud	Guess, round the number kindly, or start the watch early
Watcher	Look at one thing only, and say what you saw	Say "good", which tells the mover nothing at all
Setter	Lay the ground out, and change one thing while the mover is working	Change something dangerous, or change it to catch somebody out

Swap jobs every time. The setter is the job people enjoy most, which is exactly why the rule above matters: a setter makes the task **realistic**, never impossible.

Meet the six

The same six as last year, a year older, and this year they share the field with the rest of the school.

Pip

Red squirrel, cream vest. Quick and willing, and first over the hurdle on the cover. This year he finds out that a movement he can do once is not yet a movement he owns.

Bramble

Badger, slate vest and shorts. Strong and steady, and he never rushes. He is the one in the class who can still do, in June, everything he could do in October.

Sorrel

Hare. The fastest of all of them, and this year that gets in her way. Fluent and fast are not the same thing, and giving up her one speed is the hardest work she does.

Tuft

Hedgehog. The smallest and the most careful. He reads the whole field before he moves into it, which makes him quietly the best in the class at the last topic in this unit.



Willow

Barn owl. She watches, from up on a post where she can see the whole shape of a movement and the whole field at the same time. She is the reason this book keeps asking you to say what you saw instead of saying whether you liked it.

When you see her notes in a slate-grey panel, that is Willow telling you exactly what one body did. Copy the way she says it, not just what she says.

Rowan

Otter. Happiest in a group, very good at giving everybody a job, and this year he is usually the setter. If a cone has moved, it was Rowan.

None of the six is better than the others. Each one is good at a different thing, which is exactly how a class works, and it is why the tasks keep making you swap.

How to use this book

Every part of the field is built the same way, so once you know the shapes you always know where you are.

SHAPE	WHAT IT MEANS
Come out to the field	A question to talk about before you move. There is no wrong answer yet.
What happened	The real problem for this topic. Everything after it is you sorting that out.
On this field you will	What you will be able to do by the end. Come back and check.
Warm up	Two minutes, straight in, and it is never optional in this subject.
Do you remember?	Something from an earlier year, or an earlier topic, that you are about to need again.
Learn	The marked field and the new idea. Read the drawing first, then the words.
Watch me try	One attempt, taken slowly, with the reason for each part.
Your turn	Your work. Move first, then write, draw and tick in the book.
Willow's own notes	What a watcher actually wrote down. A model for your own.
Stay safe	Green. An instruction, not a suggestion. Read it before you move.
The equipment you need	Fetch this before you start, so nobody stands about.
Did you know?	A true thing worth knowing that is not in any test.
Go a little further	For when you have finished and want more.
Field challenge	Harder. Expect to need three attempts.
The sports day	The project at the end of this part of the field.
How did it go?	You judging your own work, honestly.
Look what I can do	The tick list. Only tick what is true today.
Words we used	Every new word, with its meaning.

The marked fields

Wherever you see a green panel with painted white lines on it, you are looking at **the space seen from above**, the way Willow sees it. The marks always mean the same thing.

MARK	MEANS
a solid white line	a line you may not cross
a dashed white line	the route your body travels
a dotted line with an open arrow	the route somebody else travels
a white ring	where a body starts, or stops
a double ring	a place two bodies both want, at the same moment
a small cross	a cone, a marker or a flag
the ticks down the left edge	paces, counted

The last two rows of that table are new this year. In Year 3 nothing needed them, because only one body moved at a time.

Writing in this book

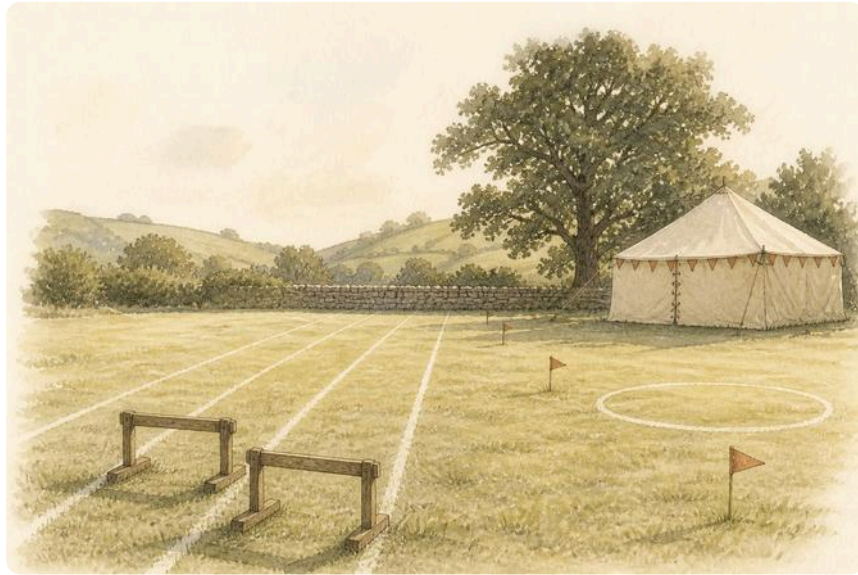
You are meant to. The pale boxes, the ruled lines and the timing tables are yours. Use a pencil, because your second attempt is usually a different number from your first, and that is the whole point.

Nothing in this book needs a screen

There is no code to scan and no page to look up. Everything you need is a body, a space, some cones and three other people. The addresses your teacher may want are in *For teachers*, at the back.

Getting set up

You do not need everything at once. Each part of the field tells you what to fetch.



The field before anybody arrives. Four lanes painted straight down the grass, two hurdles standing ready in the nearest lane, a chalked throwing circle off to one side and the marquee still laced shut. Look at how much space there is. By the middle of the morning there will be four events running on it at once.

Your field kit

- soft indoor shoes, or bare feet, or trainers, whichever your teacher says for the space
- a stopwatch, or one clock everybody can see
- eight cones, or eight of anything that stands up and does not roll away
- four bean bags, or four soft balls
- two hoops
- one low hurdle, or a cane resting on two cones at the lowest height you have
- a relay baton, or a rolled-up magazine, which works just as well
- chalk, or a roll of low-tack tape, for marking a line on the floor
- a pencil, because half of this book gets written in
- three other people, so that all four jobs are filled



Your kit, laid out. Not one thing here needs a screen. Count them against the list: shoes, a watch, a baton, four cones, two bean bags, a hoop, a tape and a clipboard. The clipboard belongs to whoever is watching.

Field rules

- 1 Walk into the space. Everybody walks in, every time, however exciting it is.
- 2 Look at the whole field before you move into it. Tuft is right about this and he is right every lesson.
- 3 Before you set off, know who else is moving and where they are going.
- 4 The timer says the number that is on the watch, not the number that would be kind.
- 5 A watcher says what they **saw**, never whether it was good.
- 6 The setter changes one thing at a time, tells nobody, and never changes anything dangerous.
- 7 Put the equipment back where it came from, at the end, without being asked.
- 8 Stop the moment you hear “stop”. Not after this one. Now.
- 9 Put your pencil down before you move. Write between goes, not during one.

STAY SAFE

Before anybody moves, check four things and say them out loud:

The floor. Dry, clear, nothing to trip on, nothing to slide on. **The edges.** Nothing hard within two paces of any line you might run past. **The apparatus.** Every hurdle, hoop, bench and mat set out and tested by an adult, not by you. **The other groups.** Where they are working, and which way they are travelling.

If any of the four is wrong, you tell an adult and you do not begin.

Rule 6 is the one that is new, and it is worth knowing why the setter exists at all. Out in a game, in a match and on a real sports day, nobody tells you that the ground has changed. You find out because you were looking. A task where nothing ever changes trains you for a field that does not exist.

What you already bring

You do not arrive at the Grass Lanes empty-handed. Almost everything this unit asks for, you have already been taught, which is why the unit can spend its time on the four new words instead.

FROM	WHAT YOU LEARNED	WHERE YOU NEED IT HERE
Year 1	the movements themselves: running, jumping, hopping, skipping, landing, stopping, throwing, balancing	every station of the round of eight, in 1.1
Year 2	playing with a team on a marked court, in bibs	sharing the field, in 1.4
Year 3	practice: one thing to change, ten goes, and somebody watching that one thing	consolidating your two weakest, in 1.1
Year 3	joining movements so that there is no stop in the middle	four movements and three joins, in 1.2
Year 3	the four dials: speed, level, size and force	fluency and variety, in 1.3
Year 3	mover, timer and watcher, and swapping every time	all four jobs, all the way through

The four new words, and where they are

There are only four new ideas at the Grass Lanes, one for each lane. Everything else on the next thirty pages is something you can already do, being asked for in a harder way.

THE WORD	WHAT IT MEANS	LANE
consolidate	Keep a movement you have, instead of perfecting one movement and quietly losing three others	1.1
variety	Use movements from different families, and find more than one answer to the same task	1.2 and 1.3
fluency	Move with no pause you did not plan. Not the same as moving fast	1.3
other people	Read where somebody else is going, and give way on purpose rather than by accident	1.4

You have finished the Grass Lanes when

- ✓ you can say what all four words mean, and show each one with your body
- ✓ your sequence comes out the same twice, on purpose
- ✓ your hesitations reach nought, at whatever speed you choose
- ✓ another group can cross your field without either of you stopping

Nothing on that list is about being the fastest, and nothing on it compares you with anybody else. Every one of them compares you with your own earlier attempt, which is the only comparison this book is interested in.



UNIT 1 · GRASS LANES

1 Moving well

At the Grass Lanes you check that everything you can do is still there, link four movements into one short sequence, take the hesitations out of it, and then perform the whole thing on a field with other people moving on it.

✓ ON THIS FIELD YOU WILL

- ✓ check your whole range of movements, and consolidate the two weakest
- ✓ link four movements from four different families, with three joins
- ✓ perform a sequence twice with no hesitation and no difference
- ✓ read where other people are going, and give way on purpose

○ COME OUT TO THE FIELD

Think about October, at the start of this school year.

Now answer the harder question. **What could you do then that you have not done since?**

Almost everybody has something. A movement does not disappear, but it goes quiet, and a quiet movement is slower and wobblier than it used to be. This unit is about finding out which of yours have gone quiet, and about waking them up without losing the rest.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.1

Keeping everything you can do

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Eight cones, four bean bags, two hoops, one low hurdle, a stopwatch and a pencil. Work in fours.

✦ WARM UP

Travel anywhere in the space for ninety seconds, changing how you travel every time your teacher calls: walking, side-stepping, skipping, jogging. Never touch anybody and never stop.

Then five shoulder rolls backwards, five rises onto your toes, and stand still. Your body is warm and your ankles are awake. Cold practice is wasted practice.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Pip is a good thrower. He has been throwing all term and he is better at it than anybody.

Rowan asks the four of them to do a two-handed catch, a hop and a balance on one foot. Pip drops the catch, hops well, and puts a foot down out of the balance after two seconds.

“I can do all of those,” says Pip.

“You could do all of those in October,” says Willow.

► Learn

Your **range** is everything your body can do. It is much bigger than you think, and it is not all in the same condition.

Every movement in your range is in one of three states.

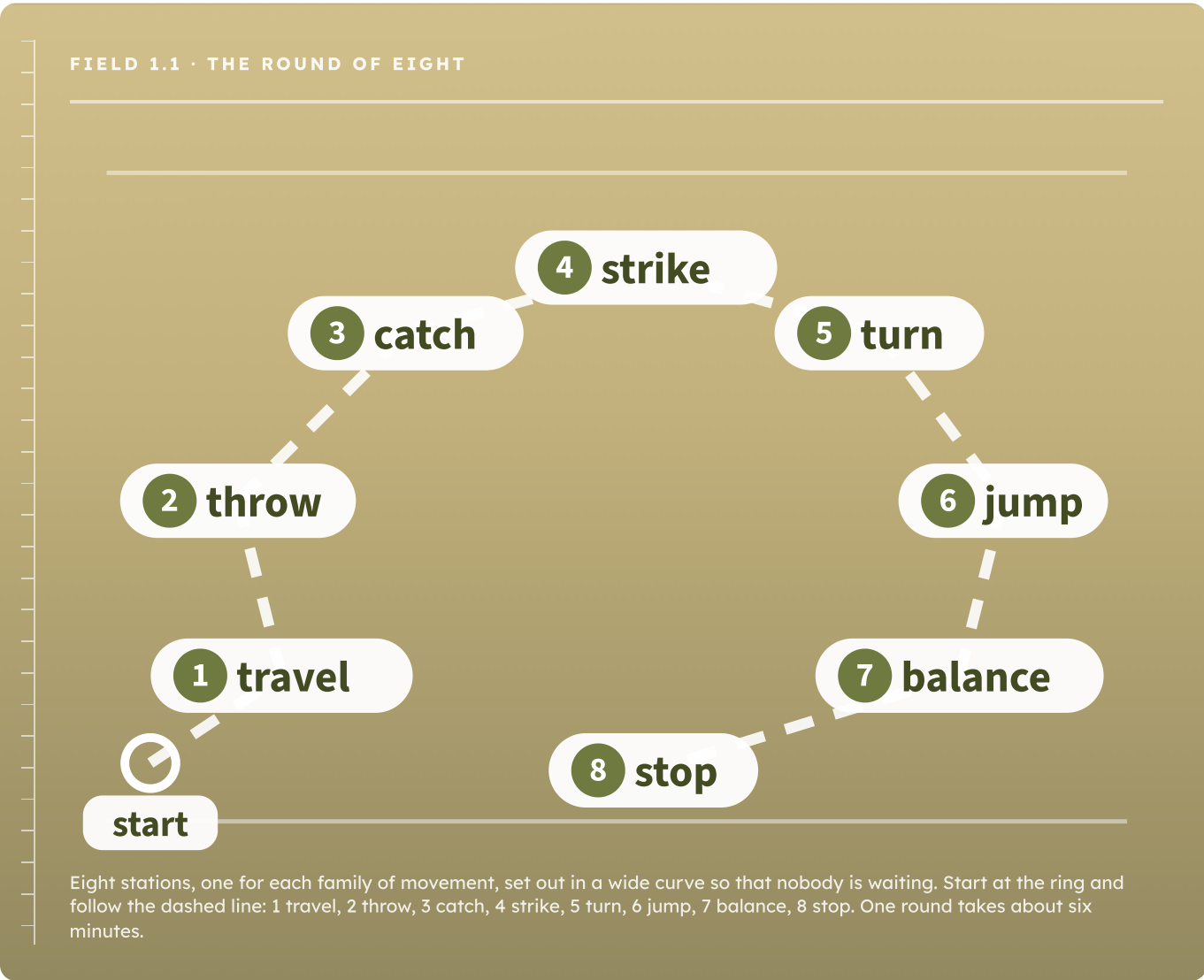
STATE	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT IT NEEDS
new	You are still learning it. Some goes work and some do not.	Teaching, then practice
working	You can do it, but not every time, and not without thinking.	Consolidating
kept	You can do it today, first go, without warming up to it.	Using now and then

Consolidating means moving a movement from *working* to *kept*, and then keeping it there. It is the whole job of this topic, and it is not the same as practising one thing until it is beautiful, which is what you did last year.

Here is the difficulty. You cannot practise everything in one lesson. So you do this instead:

- ✓ **check** the whole range quickly, and be honest about the state of each part
- ✓ **choose** the two weakest, and only those two
- ✓ **consolidate** them properly, ten goes each, the way you learned last year
- ✓ **check again**, including things you already had, to be sure you did not lose them

That last step is the one everybody skips. A class that spends six weeks on throwing usually cannot catch as well at the end of it as at the beginning.



The eight stations are the eight **families** of movement you use in Year 4. Every movement you know belongs to one of them.

FAMILY	AT THE STATION YOU
travel	cross ten paces on your feet, any way you like, without slowing
throw	throw a bean bag to a partner, overarm, from six paces
catch	catch a bean bag thrown to you, with two hands, from six paces
strike or kick	send a ball between two cones from four paces

FAMILY	AT THE STATION YOU
turn	turn all the way round while travelling, without stopping
jump and land	jump into a hoop and land still
balance	hold a still shape on one foot to a count of five
stop	travel fast and stop dead on a chalk line, both feet behind it

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

The hardest event in athletics is not one event. The **decathlon** is ten of them, held over two days, and the order never changes. Day one: 100 metres, long jump, shot put, high jump, 400 metres. Day two: 110 metres hurdles, discus, pole vault, javelin, 1500 metres.

Read that list again and notice what it asks for. Sprinting, then jumping, then throwing, then sprinting again the next morning, on tired legs.

A decathlete's problem is never how to get good at one of the ten. It is how to keep all ten at once, which is exactly the problem on this page.



Halfway round. Bramble is at station 3 with the bean bag arriving, and his hands are already up and open, which is the one thing he set out to change. Behind him the next three stations are waiting: a hoop, two cones and a hurdle. Rowan has the second bag ready so that nobody stands about.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Bramble does the round of eight, and Willow writes down the state of each one honestly.

NO.	STATION	WHAT HAPPENED	STATE
1	travel	ten paces, no slowing	kept
2	throw	six of six reached Rowan	kept
3	catch	three of six, hands late twice	working
4	strike	four of six between the cones	kept
5	turn	turned, but slowed to do it	working
6	jump	into the hoop, landed still	kept
7	balance	five counts, no wobble	kept
8	stop	dead on the line, both feet behind	kept

Two are *working*: the catch and the turn. So Bramble consolidates the **catch**, and he does it the Year 3 way: one thing to change, ten goes, somebody watching that one thing.

His one thing to change is *hands up and ready before the bag arrives*.

GO	HANDS	CAUGHT
1	came up as the bag arrived	no
4	up early, then dropped	yes
7	up early, stayed up	yes
10	up early, stayed up	yes

Then he does the part that matters most, and it takes two minutes: he goes back and repeats stations **2, 6 and 8**, which were already *kept*.

All three still are. That is the proof that he consolidated the catch instead of trading it for something else.

✱ WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Round one, station 3: hands started by his sides and came up as the bag arrived. Late, three times out of six.

Round two, station 3: hands up and open before Rowan let go. Caught all four.

Round two, stations 2, 6 and 8: same as round one. Nothing lost.

Notice the last line. A watcher's job in this topic is not only to watch the thing being practised. It is to check that the rest of the range came out the other side.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Do the round of eight. At each station, tick the state that is true today. Be honest: this table is only useful if it is.

NO.	STATION	NEW	WORKING	KEPT
1	travel	_____	_____	_____
2	throw	_____	_____	_____
3	catch	_____	_____	_____
4	strike	_____	_____	_____
5	turn	_____	_____	_____
6	jump	_____	_____	_____
7	balance	_____	_____	_____
8	stop	_____	_____	_____

- 2 Write your two weakest stations, and pick **one** of them to consolidate today.

My two weakest are

Today I will consolidate _____ and the one thing I will change is

3 Ten goes at that one station. Your watcher looks only at your one thing.

GO	WHAT THE WATCHER SAW	WORKED?
1	_____	_____
4	_____	_____
7	_____	_____
10	_____	_____

4 Now the step people skip. Go back to **three stations you scored as kept** and do them once each. Are they still kept?

STATION	STILL KEPT?	IF NOT, WHAT HAPPENED?
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

5 Tick every one that is true.

- ☐ My weakest station moved from working towards kept.
- ☐ The three stations I checked again were still kept.
- ☐ I was more tired at the end, and one of them was worse because of that.

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Swap jobs and score your partner's round of eight as the watcher, without telling them what you have written.

Then compare your table with theirs. Where you disagree, the movement is almost always *working* rather than *kept*: a mover feels the good goes and a watcher counts all of them.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.2

Four movements, three joins

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Two hoops, one low hurdle, four cones, chalk or tape for one line, and a mat if your space has them. Work in fours.

↺ DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 1.1, name the three states a movement in your range can be in.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Sorrel builds a sequence. She runs round the first cone, runs round the second cone, and runs round the third cone, fast and smoothly, and finishes on the line.

“Four movements,” says Sorrel. “Run, run, run, stop.”

“One movement three times, and then a stop,” says Willow.

► **Learn**

Last year a sequence was three movements with two joins in it. This year it is **four movements and three joins**, and there is a new rule about *which* four.

A **family** is a group of movements that do the same job: travelling, jumping, turning, balancing, throwing, catching, rolling, stopping. Sorrel's sequence used one family three times, which is why it did not count.

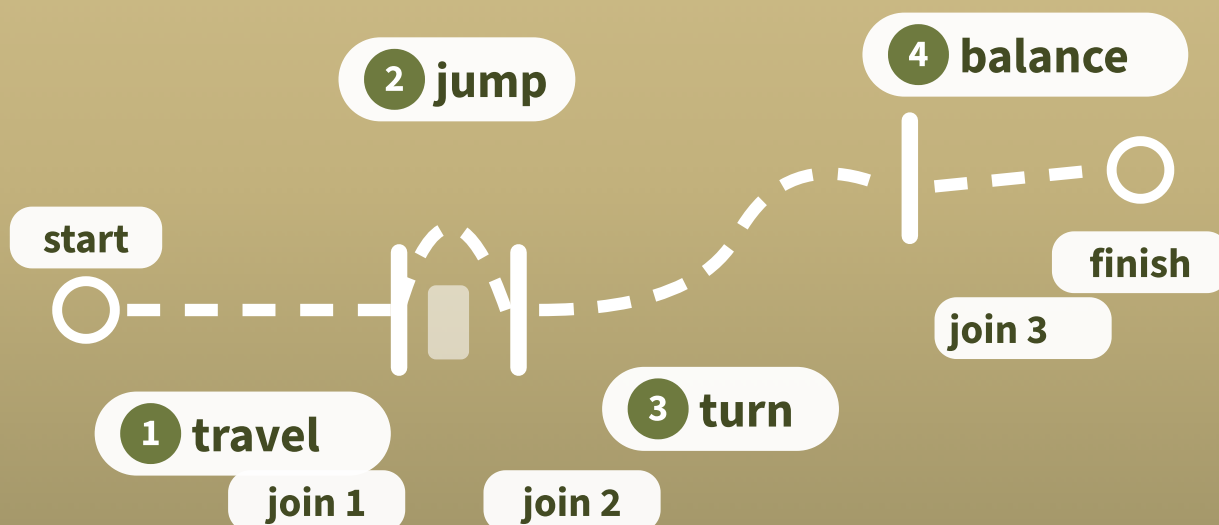
Two rules make a Year 4 sequence.

THE RULE	WHAT IT MEANS	WHY
Variety	The four movements come from four different families , and no family twice in a row	Linking a run to a run teaches you nothing. Linking a run to a balance is where the work is
Repeatable	You can perform it twice and a watcher cannot tell the two goes apart	A sequence you can only do once was luck, not a sequence

The joins are still the hard part, and now you have three of them. The middle one, join 2, is nearly always the weakest, because by then you have used up the speed the run gave you and you are not yet close enough to the end to be careful.

At every join, ask the Year 3 question: **can I begin the next movement from exactly where this one left me?** If the answer is no, the join is what you practise, not the movements.

FIELD 1.2 · FOUR MOVEMENTS, THREE JOINS



Four movements from four families, numbered 1 to 4, and the three thick upright marks between them are the joins. The pale rectangle is the low hurdle. Look at join 2: it is where the jump has to turn into a turn, and it is the one that goes wrong. The finish is a balance, held on the spot.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

A **4 by 100 metres relay** team is four runners and three baton changeovers, which is the same shape as the sequence on this page.

The baton has to be passed inside a marked takeover zone. Until 2017 that zone was a 20 metre box with a separate 10 metre acceleration zone in front of it. World Athletics then merged the two into a single **30 metre takeover zone**, which is what the rules say today.

Why change it? Because the changeovers are where relays are lost. Four fast runners with three poor joins are beaten by four ordinary runners who can pass a baton.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Pip builds run, hurdle, turn, balance. Four families, three joins.

Attempt 1. He runs, clears the hurdle, turns, and puts his foot down twice getting into the balance. *Joins 1 and 2 worked. Join 3 failed: he arrived at the balance with too much speed left.*

Attempt 2. He tightens the turn so that it takes the speed out for him, and arrives at the balance slower. *Join 3 worked.* Now join 2 is untidy, because the tighter turn needs him to land the hurdle facing further round.

Attempt 3. He lands the hurdle with his shoulders already turning, tightens the turn, and arrives at the balance ready. *All three joins worked.*

Attempt 4. He does the whole thing again and Willow cannot tell attempt 4 from attempt 3.

Attempt 4 is the one that counts. Attempts 1 to 3 built the sequence; attempt 4 proved he owns it.



Join 2, while he is still in the air. Look at Pip's head and his front paws. Both point at the hoop lying on the grass ahead of him, not down at the bar he is crossing. He has already begun the next movement. Bramble has the clipboard, and notice that he is writing between goes rather than during one.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Build a sequence of four movements from **four different families**. Write your four in order, and write the family beside each one.

OUR SEQUENCE

1

2

3

4

Three joins. Mark each one with an arrow.

- 2 Perform it twice. Your watcher does not judge it: they say which **join** was different between go 1 and go 2.

THE JOIN THAT DIFFERED	WHAT WAS DIFFERENT ABOUT IT

- 3 Now practise that one join, four times, and perform the whole sequence twice more.

GO	WEAKEST JOIN	COULD A WATCHER TELL THE TWO GOES APART?
1		
2		

- 4 Tick every one that is true of your last go.

- ☐ Four movements, from four different families.
- ☐ No stop at any of the three joins.
- ☐ My two performances were the same as each other.

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Perform your sequence twice, one straight after the other, so that a watcher who has never seen it cannot say which go was which.

If they can tell, do not explain. Ask them which join gave it away, practise that join, and go again. A sequence that comes out differently every time is still *working*, not *kept*.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.3

Fluent, not fast**■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED**

Four cones, two hoops, one low hurdle, a stopwatch and a pencil. Work in fours.

✦ WARM UP

Cross the space four times without stopping at either end: walking, side-stepping, skipping, jogging. The turn at the end counts as part of the crossing, so do not stop to do it.

Almost everybody stops at the turn on the first two crossings. Notice when you do.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Sorrel performs her four-movement sequence in nine seconds. It looks rushed.

Tuft performs his in fourteen seconds. It looks finished.

Willow is not timing them. She is counting something else, and her numbers are Sorrel three and Tuft nought.

► **Learn**

Willow is counting **hesitations**.

A hesitation is a pause you did not plan. It is not the same as a slow movement. A slow movement is a choice you made, and it can be perfectly fluent.

Fluency means the whole sequence runs without hesitations and without gaps: every movement begins from where the last one left you.

Three things cause hesitations, and they need three different fixes.

THE CAUSE	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	THE FIX
You are looking for the next thing	A small pause with the head turning	Learn the order until you do not have to think about it
You arrived somewhere you cannot leave	A pause with the feet shuffling	Change the finish of the movement before it
You changed your mind	A pause, then something different from the plan	Decide before you start, and perform the plan you decided

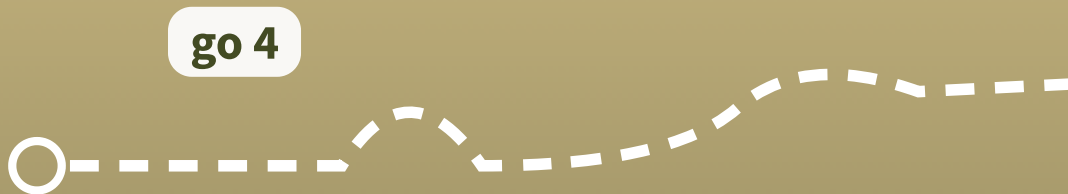
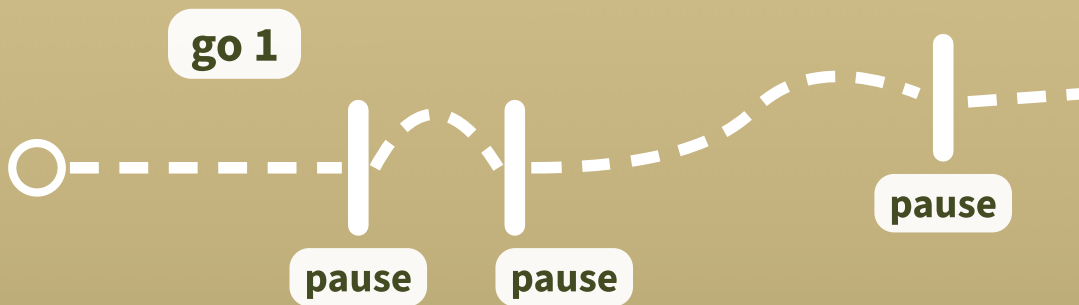
Now the second half of this topic, and it is a new word too. **Variety** means solving the same task in more than one way. Two goes that are equally fluent but *different* prove more than one perfect go, because they show you understood the task rather than memorised one answer.

FAST	FLUENT
Measured with a stopwatch	Counted in hesitations
Can be got by hurrying	Cannot be got by hurrying
Usually looks rushed at this age	Looks finished, at any speed
One setting only	Works at any speed you choose

🔄 DO YOU REMEMBER?

From Year 3, name the four dials you can change without changing the movement itself.

FIELD 1.3 · THE SAME ROUTE, TWICE: THREE HESITATIONS, THEN NONE



one unbroken line, same route, same speed

Both routes are the same four movements. The three thick bars across go 1 are hesitations: pauses nobody planned. On go 4 the paint is one unbroken line. Nothing has been done faster. The gaps have simply gone.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

Carlos Lopes ran the marathon for Portugal. He won the Olympic marathon in Los Angeles in 1984, in an Olympic record of 2 hours 9 minutes and 21 seconds, and he finished about 200 metres ahead of everybody else. He was 37 years old. The following April, at the age of 38, he set the world record for the marathon in Rotterdam: 2 hours 7 minutes and 12 seconds. He was the last European to hold that record, and he held it for three years.

Look at the words “Olympic record” again. That is not a burst of speed somewhere in the middle. It is 42 kilometres held together without a single gap, which is what this whole page is about.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Tuft performs his sequence three times. Bramble times him. Willow counts the hesitations only.

GO	TIME	HESITATIONS	WHERE, AND WHY
1	14 s	2	after the jump, looking for the hoop; before the balance, feet shuffling
2	13 s	1	before the balance, still arriving too fast
3	13 s	0	none. He turned tighter, so he arrived ready

Read the middle column, then read the one beside it.

One second separates go 1 from go 3, and a second is nothing. What actually changed is that two pauses disappeared. If Bramble had only had the stopwatch, he would have reported that Tuft got almost nothing better.

Then Tuft does the **variety** half. He performs the same task with a different answer: he swaps the jump for a roll and takes the turn the other way.

Same task, different sequence, and still no hesitations. Now he can prove he understood the task, and not just remembered one route.

* WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Go 1: paused after the jump and looked across at the hoop before setting off again. Paused again before the balance, two small steps.

Go 3: no pause anywhere. Came off the jump already facing the hoop, and arrived at the balance slowly enough to hold it first time.

Second version: different movements, same shape, no pauses. He did not go faster. He stopped stopping.

Willow never writes “much better”. She writes what the head did, what the feet did and where the pause was. That is why Tuft knew which second to work on.



Even, and in no hurry. Sorrel is the fastest in the class and this is her working on the harder thing. Look at her shoulders: they are level, and she is upright. She is not slowing down and she is not speeding up, which is what a fluent middle of a sequence looks like.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Perform your sequence from 1.2 three times. Your timer writes the time. Your watcher counts **only** the hesitations, and says where each one was.

GO	TIME	HESITATIONS	WHERE WAS THE FIRST ONE?
1	_____	_____	_____
2	_____	_____	_____
3	_____	_____	_____

2 Which of the three causes was your first hesitation? Tick one.

- ☐ I was looking for the next thing.
- ☐ I arrived somewhere I could not leave.
- ☐ I changed my mind.

3 How much did your **time** change between go 1 and go 3, and how much did your **hesitations** change?

Time changed by _____ Hesitations changed by _____

4 Now the variety half. Perform the same task a **different way**: change two of the four movements, or take the route the other way round. Write both versions.

VERSION	THE FOUR MOVEMENTS	HESITATIONS
A	_____	_____
B	_____	_____

5 Tick what is true.

- ☐ My hesitations went down while my time stayed about the same.
- ☐ Both my versions were fluent.
- ☐ One version was fluent and the other one is not finished yet.

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Perform your fluent version with one dial turned right down: as slowly as you possibly can, holding that speed all the way through.

The hesitations usually come back, and that is worth knowing. Slow is where a gap shows, which is exactly why judges ask gymnasts to perform slowly.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.4

A field with other people on it

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Eight cones, four bean bags, two hoops, one low hurdle and chalk. Work in fours, then two fours together on one field.

🚩 STAY SAFE

From here to the end of the unit, more than one group works on the same field. Four rules, and none of them is negotiable.

- 1 **Look at the whole field before you set off**, not only at your own route.
- 2 **Decide before you move.** At any place where two routes cross, agree who changes their line and who changes their timing.
- 3 **One mover on any piece of apparatus at a time.** Wait behind a cone, never beside the hurdle.
- 4 **If you are about to arrive together, both slow down.** Nobody wins a crossing.

🔄 DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 1.3, what exactly is a hesitation?

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Rowan sets out one hoop for two groups to share.

Tuft and Rowan set off at the same moment, both heading for the hoop. Both stop. Both apologise. Both wait. Both set off again.

It happens again.

“Twice,” says Willow. “You are both being polite, and neither of you is deciding.”

► Learn

This is the topic that makes Year 4 different from Year 3. Last year one body moved at a time. From now on the field is shared, and there are two new things to handle: **other people**, and **a ground that changes while you work**.

Before you set off, read three things about everybody else who is moving.

READ	THE QUESTION	HOW YOU FIND OUT
Where	Where are they going?	Look at their feet and their shoulders, not their face
When	Will they get there before me, with me, or after me?	Count: one, two, three, as you both travel
What job	What are they doing, and what are they allowed to do?	The task, or the rules of the game

Then use the rule that stops the scenario above from happening for ever.

At a crossing point, one of you changes line and the other changes timing.

If you both change line you meet in the new place. If you both change timing you both stop, which is what Tuft and Rowan kept doing. It does not matter which of you does

which, and it does not have to be fair every time. It has to be **decided**.

There is one more thing, and it is the setter’s job. In a real game nobody warns you that the ground has changed. So the setter moves one thing while you work, and you use the Year 3 rule: **keep the movement, change the detail**.

KIND OF ACTIVITY	WHO DECIDES WHO GIVES WAY	EXAMPLE
You choose it (self-selected)	You do, out loud, before you move	Two groups sharing one field for their sequences
Structured	The rules do	In a game, the player without the ball usually gives way

FIELD 1.4 · ONE CROSSING, TWO WAYS TO SOLVE IT

you

them

you both want this

change your LINE

they keep theirs

change your TIMING

wait one count

On the left, two routes cross and the double ring is the place you both want at the same moment. In the middle, you curve behind and they hold their line. On the right, you keep your line and wait one count at the short bar. Both work. Doing both at once does not.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

Futsal is football played five against five on a hard court 40 metres long and 20 metres wide, about the size of a handball court. The court, the ball and the rules all favour close control and passing in small spaces.

Ten players inside 800 square metres means somebody is always about to cross your line, so a futsal player reads the other nine almost constantly.

Portugal won the Futsal World Cup in 2021, in Lithuania, beating Argentina 2 to 1 in the final. It was the first time Portugal had won it.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Rowan puts one hoop out for two groups. Tuft and Rowan both need it.

Attempt 1. Both set off. Both stop. Both wait. Nothing happens. *Nobody decided.*

Attempt 2. They decide first: Rowan holds his line, Tuft changes his timing and waits one count before setting off. Both get to the hoop, one after the other, and neither stops once they are moving.

Attempt 3. They swap. Tuft holds his line and Rowan curves behind him, changing his line instead. It works just as well, and Rowan travels slightly further.

Attempt 4. While they are working, Rowan the setter moves the hoop two paces to the left without telling anybody. Tuft sees it as he sets off, changes one detail, a longer first stride, and keeps the sequence. Nothing else about his movement changes.

Attempt 4 is the Year 4 objective in one go: the ground changed, and the movement survived it.



Two routes, one crossing. Find the two painted lines meeting in the grass in front of them. Rowan is holding his line straight across it. Tuft, who agreed to change his timing, is travelling but has not gone into the gap yet, and he is watching Rowan while he waits. Clear grass between them, and neither of them has stopped.

• YOUR TURN

- Two groups, one field. Draw both routes on the field below: yours as a dashed line, the other group's as a dotted line with an arrow. Ring the place you both want.

BOTH ROUTES, SEEN FROM ABOVE, WITH THE CROSSING RINGED

- Decide **before** anybody moves, and write it down.

At our crossing, _____ changes line and
 _____ changes timing.

- 3 Three goes. After each one, write what you read and what you changed.

GO	WHAT I READ ABOUT THE OTHER GROUP	WHAT I CHANGED	DID ANYBODY STOP?
1			
2			
3			

- 4 On go 3, the setter changes one thing without telling you. Write what changed, and the one detail of your movement you changed to deal with it.

What the setter changed

The one detail I changed

- 5 Tick every one that is true.

- ☐ We decided who gives way before we moved, not while we were moving.
- ☐ Nobody stopped and nobody touched anybody.
- ☐ The ground changed and I kept my sequence.

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Perform your sequence while two other groups cross the same field, and keep all four movements, all three joins and nought hesitations.

Then swap: be one of the groups crossing while somebody else performs. It is harder, and it is the half everybody forgets to practise.

The sports day

Six friends, four jobs, one field, and everything from the Grass Lanes at once.

You will check your range, build a short sequence, take the hesitations out of it, perform it on a shared field while other people move, and have a watcher describe it back to you. Your work is finished when the watcher’s description matches what you meant to do.

A SPORTS DAY SEQUENCE IS GOOD WHEN	IT IS WEAK WHEN
the four movements come from four different families	it uses one family twice in a row
it can be performed twice with no difference a watcher can name	it comes out differently every time
it runs with nought hesitations	it has pauses nobody planned
it survives another group crossing the field	it only works on an empty field
it survives the setter moving one thing	it falls apart when a cone moves
a watcher can describe it without asking you	you have to explain it first



The sports day. Three of them performing, three of them watching, and the watchers have the clipboards. Nobody is being marked and nobody is winning. Everybody is being described.

THE SPORTS DAY · THE FIVE STEPS

- 1 **Check what you have.** One round of eight. Write the state of each station, and consolidate the weakest one before you build anything.
- 2 **Build it.** Four movements from four families, three joins, on a field you draw before you move.
- 3 **Make it flow.** Perform it until the hesitations reach nought. Your timer times it, but the hesitation count is the number that matters.
- 4 **Share the field.** Perform it while another group crosses. Decide the crossing before anybody moves. The setter changes one thing on the last go.
- 5 **Be described.** A watcher writes down all four movements, all three joins, the hesitations and what you did about the other group, without speaking to you.

What good looks like: their description and your plan say the same thing.

Step 5 is the one that matters, and it is the one everybody wants to argue about. If the watcher wrote “then he sort of waited for the other group”, you did wait. The watcher is not being unfair. They are being a mirror, which is the most useful thing a person can be.

Our sequence, written down before we move

OUR SPORTS DAY SEQUENCE

1

2

3

4

The weakest station we consolidated first, and the crossing we agreed:

OUR FIELD, DRAWN BEFORE WE MOVED

WHAT THE WATCHER WROTE AFTERWARDS

* WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Four movements: a run, a jump off the hurdle, a turn, and a balance held on one foot.

Joins 1 and 3 were clean. Join 2 had a small pause in it on the first go and none on the second.

Hesitations: one, then nought.

The other group crossed after his jump. He changed his timing, waited one count, and did not lose the turn.

Held the balance past three. Same sequence both times.

That is what a full description looks like. It names the movements, judges each join separately, counts the hesitations, says what happened at the crossing, and says what the finish did. Not one word of it says whether Willow enjoyed it.

How did it go?

Colour one ring in each row: green for yes, amber for nearly, red for not yet. Answer for today, not for your best ever go.

AT THE GRASS LANES	YES / NEARLY / NOT YET
I checked my whole range honestly, and named my two weakest	☐ ☐ ☐
I consolidated one of them, and did not lose the others	☐ ☐ ☐
My sequence used four movements from four different families	☐ ☐ ☐

AT THE GRASS LANES	YES / NEARLY / NOT YET
I performed it twice and a watcher could not tell them apart	☐ ☐ ☐
My hesitations reached nought	☐ ☐ ☐
I solved the same task a second, different way	☐ ☐ ☐
I decided a crossing before I moved, and kept moving	☐ ☐ ☐
The setter changed something and I kept my sequence	☐ ☐ ☐
As a watcher, I said what I saw instead of saying “good”	☐ ☐ ☐
As a setter, I changed one thing fairly and never anything dangerous	☐ ☐ ☐

The last two rows are worth as much as the eight about moving. A class where nobody watches properly is a class where nobody improves, because there is no way to find out whether anything changed. And a class where the setter cheats is a class that stops trusting the task.

☐ LOOK WHAT I CAN DO

- ☐ check my whole range of movements, and say which are kept and which are working
- ☐ consolidate a working movement without losing the ones I already had
- ☐ name the eight families of movement
- ☐ link four movements from four different families with three joins
- ☐ perform the same sequence twice with no difference a watcher can name
- ☐ count hesitations, in my own performance and in somebody else's
- ☐ tell the difference between moving fast and moving fluently
- ☐ solve the same movement task in two different ways
- ☐ read where another person is going, when they will get there, and what their job is
- ☐ decide a crossing before I move, by changing my line or my timing

- ☐ keep my movement when the ground changes underneath it

Words we used

Eighteen words. You used every one of them at the Grass Lanes.

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS
range	Everything your body can do. Bigger than you think, and not all of it in the same condition.
consolidate	To move a movement from <i>working</i> to <i>kept</i> , and then keep it there.
kept	A movement you can do today, first go, without warming up to it.
working	A movement you can do, but not every time, and not without thinking about it.
family	A group of movements that do the same job: travelling, jumping, turning, balancing, throwing, catching, striking, stopping.
sequence	Four or more movements joined so that there is no stop in the middle.
join	The place where one movement becomes the next. Three of them in a Year 4 sequence.
variety	Using movements from different families, and being able to solve the same task more than one way.
repeatable	Able to be performed twice with no difference a watcher can name.
fluency	Moving with no hesitation and no gap. Not the same as moving fast.
hesitation	A pause you did not plan. Countable, which is why the watcher counts them.
control	Ending a movement where and how you meant to, every time and not by luck.
adapt	To change small details of a movement so that it still works when the ground changes.
context	Everything around the movement: the space, the equipment, the rules and the other people.
crossing	A place where two routes want the same patch of ground at the same moment.
give way	To let somebody else through, by changing your line or your timing, on purpose and decided in advance.
structured	An activity where rules decide what happens, such as a game.

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS
self-selected	An activity you choose and arrange yourselves.

The four jobs

JOB	IN ONE LINE
mover	Does the movement, properly, as many times as the task asks.
timer	Counts or times, and says the real number out loud.
watcher	Looks at one thing, and says what they saw, not whether they liked it.
setter	Lays the ground out, and changes one thing while the mover is working.

Answers for Unit 1

Some tasks in this unit have one right answer. Most do not, because a movement task is answered with a body and no two bodies answer it the same way. Where there is no single answer, this page says what a good answer must contain instead. Teachers can mark from the right-hand column without having seen the lesson.

1.1 Keeping everything you can do

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Practise 1, the round of eight	Eight rows, one state ticked in each. Look for a mixture : a pupil who ticks <i>kept</i> eight times has not been honest, and a pupil who ticks <i>new</i> eight times has misread the task, because Years 1 to 3 taught all eight families.
Practise 2, the two weakest and the one thing to change	The one thing must be about the body , and specific: “hands up before the bag arrives”, “look at the line, not my feet”. Reject “catch better”, “be smoother” and “try harder”, which name no body part and cannot be watched.
Practise 3, the table of ten goes	Four rows completed, from goes 1, 4, 7 and 10. The watcher’s column must describe the one chosen thing each time, not the whole movement.
Practise 4, the three stations checked again	This is the task that carries the objective. Three stations previously scored <i>kept</i> , done once each, with an honest yes or no. A pupil who lost one has still passed the task if they noticed and wrote why: the commonest true reason is tiredness. A pupil who did not check has not done the topic.

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Practise 5, ticks	All three may be ticked. The third, “one was worse because I was tired”, is a correct and useful answer and must not be marked down.
Go a little further, scoring a partner’s round	Expect disagreement on two or three stations. The rule to teach from it: where mover and watcher disagree, the movement is <i>working</i> rather than <i>kept</i> , because a mover remembers the good goes and a watcher counts all of them.

1.2 Four movements, three joins

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Do you remember, the three states	New, working, kept. All three needed, in any order.
Practise 1, four movements from four families	Four movements, each from a different family, written in performance order, with the family named. Reject two movements from one family, and reject any family used twice in a row even if the movements have different names, for example “run” and “sprint”.
Practise 2, which join differed	A named join, 1, 2 or 3, with what was different about it. Expect join 2 most often. A pupil who writes the whole sequence again instead of naming the join has not done the task.
Practise 3, two more goes	Two rows, each naming the weakest join and answering whether a watcher could tell the goes apart. Improvement means the answer moves from yes towards no.
Practise 4, ticks	All three may be true. The third, “my two performances were the same”, is the one that decides whether the sequence is <i>kept</i> .
Field challenge	Passed only when a watcher who has not seen the sequence cannot say which of two consecutive performances was which.

1.3 Fluent, not fast

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Practise 1, three goes	Three times and three hesitation counts, with the place of the first hesitation named. Expect the count to fall while the time barely moves.
Practise 2, which cause	Any of the three, with the pupil’s own description matching it. “Looking for the next thing” pairs with a pause and a turning head; “arrived somewhere I could not leave” pairs with shuffling feet.

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Practise 3, time change against hesitation change	The point of the topic. A typical honest answer is a time change of one second or less and a hesitation change of two or three. A pupil whose time fell a great deal has probably hurried, which usually shows as a hesitation count that did not fall.
Practise 4, two versions	Two different sets of four movements answering the same task, each with its own hesitation count. Both should use four families. Accept a version that is not yet fluent, provided the pupil says so in task 5.
Practise 5, ticks	The third box, “one version is not finished yet”, is an honest pass, not a fail.
Go a little further, the slow version	Hesitations usually reappear. Any answer that notices this has met the objective, including one that says the slow version was worse.
Do you remember, the four dials	Speed, level, size, force. All four needed, in any order.

1.4 A field with other people on it

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Do you remember, what a hesitation is	A pause the mover did not plan. Accept any wording that contains “did not plan” or “unplanned”. Not simply “a stop” and not “going slowly”.
Practise 1, both routes drawn	Two routes drawn with the correct marks, the pupil’s own dashed and the other group’s dotted with an arrow, and the crossing ringed. Both routes must be drawn; a plan with only one route on it has missed the whole topic.
Practise 2, decided in advance	One named person changing line and a different named person changing timing . Both changing the same thing is the error the scenario is built on: reject it and send them back to decide again.
Practise 3, three goes	Three rows. The “what I read” column must name where the other group was going or when they would arrive, not what the other group is called. “Did anybody stop?” should reach no by go 3.
Practise 4, the setter’s change	Two answers: what the setter moved, and the one detail the mover changed. A pupil who rebuilt the whole sequence has not adapted it. A pupil who says “nothing changed” should be asked whether they were looking.
Practise 5, ticks	All three may be true. The first is the one to insist on: deciding before moving, not while moving.
Field challenge	Passed when the sequence keeps four movements, three joins and nought hesitations while two other groups cross, and then again with the pupil in the crossing role. Both halves are needed.

The sports day

STEP	WHAT A FINISHED PROJECT LOOKS LIKE
1 Check what you have	A completed round of eight, with the weakest station consolidated before any sequence was built.
2 Build it	Four movements from four families, three joins, and the field drawn before anybody moved.
3 Make it flow	A hesitation count that reaches nought, or an honest record of why it did not.
4 Share the field	A crossing agreed in advance, performed with another group crossing, and one setter change absorbed on the last go.
5 Be described	A watcher's written description naming all four movements, all three joins, the hesitations and what happened at the crossing.
The comparison	The plan and the description side by side, with the differences named. Finding a difference is a pass, not a fail. A group that finds none has usually not looked.

Sources for Unit 1

Every fact in a *Did you know?* panel was checked against the source named here on 2026-08-11. Nothing in this unit is recalled or estimated. Two of the four rest on the governing body's own pages.

WHERE IT APPEARS	THE CLAIM	CHECKED AGAINST
1.1 <i>Did you know?</i>	The decathlon is ten disciplines over two days, in a fixed order	worldathletics.org, decathlon discipline page
1.2 <i>Did you know?</i>	Four runners, three baton changeovers, and one 30 metre takeover zone since the 10 metre acceleration zone and 20 metre box were merged	worldathletics.org, summary of competition rule amendments, June 2018
1.3 <i>Did you know?</i>	Carlos Lopes won the 1984 Olympic marathon for Portugal in an Olympic record 2:09:21 at the age of 37, and set the world record 2:07:12 at Rotterdam in April 1985	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Carlos_Lopes

WHERE IT APPEARS	THE CLAIM	CHECKED AGAINST
1.4 <i>Did you know?</i>	Futsal is five against five on a 40 by 20 metre court, and Portugal won the 2021 Futsal World Cup in Lithuania, beating Argentina 2 to 1	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Futsal and the 2021 FIFA Futsal World Cup article

Where to find more, for the teacher

Both addresses were opened and read on 2026-08-11. Neither needs an account and neither charges. They were carried as pupil-facing square codes in the first draft; teacher feedback on 2026-08-12 was that a professional resource site is not an adequate destination for a nine-year-old, which is right, so they sit here instead, where the audience matches.

FOR	ADDRESS	WHAT IS THERE
1.1	youthsporttrust.org/free-resources	Twelve free resources from the Youth Sport Trust, a registered charity in the United Kingdom, charity number 1086915. The 60 Second Physical Activity Challenges are built on the principle of topic 1.1: a pupil measures against their own last attempt, and the same challenge can be re-measured later in the year, which is when a movement quietly slips from <i>kept</i> back to <i>working</i> . Registration is offered but not required.
1.4	thenational.academy, Key Stage 2 physical education units	65 free units for Years 3 to 6 from Oak National Academy, funded by the Department for Education: “Free, and always will be. No paywalls, package tiers, or hidden costs.” The Year 4 unit that matches topic 1.4 is Invasion games: maintaining possession and stopping an attack in ball games , six lessons on passing, receiving, creating space and defending.
Term days	thenational.academy, Year 4 Athletics: athletic challenges developed	Six lessons that map onto Athletics Day almost exactly: sprinting at speed, stride pattern, pacing, tactics for distance, javelin, standing triple jump.

For teachers

What this unit is for

Unit 1 covers the four Year 4 *Moving Well* objectives from PDF/Input/Student Book/Y4 Physical Education - Student Book.xlsx: practising, refining and consolidating a

broad range of movement skills (1.1), linking a wider variety of skills into short sequences (1.2), displaying control, fluency and variety (1.3), and applying movement competence in self-selected and structured activities while responding to changing contexts and to other people (1.4).

It deliberately does **not** re-teach the movements themselves, and it does not repeat Year 3. Year 3 refined **one** movement and joined **three**. The Year 4 wording adds four new words, and the four topics are those four words: *consolidate*, *variety*, *fluency*, and *others*.

If a pupil cannot yet land softly or stop where they meant to, the Year 1 and Year 3 material is the right place to go, not a slower version of this unit.

The pedagogical spine

The unit rests on one move: **the class works in fours, as mover, timer, watcher and setter, and the jobs rotate**. Year 3 used three of those jobs. The fourth is new and it is what makes objective 1.4 teachable:

- The setter changes one thing while the mover is working, which is the only honest way to practise adapting to a changing context. A task in which nothing ever changes trains a pupil for a field that does not exist.
- It occupies the three pupils who are not moving, which is what usually goes wrong in a primary Physical Education lesson.
- It gives every pupil a number or a description about their **own** earlier attempt, which is the only comparison this book permits.

Groups of four are therefore not a suggestion. This is recorded as an open question for a project manager in 01-DESIGN.md sec 12.4, because it is a subject-level decision rather than a decision for one title.

The three term days

Your sports year at the front of the book prints the three assessment days the school named on 2026-08-12. They are what the Input's single row, "Test term 1, term 2 and term3", actually means, and they are the reason this unit is worth teaching before Christmas.

TERM	DATE	DAY	ACTIVITIES
1	16 December 2026	Athletics Day	sprint · relays · standing long jump · target throw · obstacle race
2	17 March 2027	Football Day	dribbling in and out of the cones · passing accuracy · penalty shootout · full game
3	17 June 2027	Multi-sports Day	bowling · sack racing · bean bag throw · water pong

Unit 1 feeds Athletics Day directly. Four of its five events are stations in the round of eight (1.1), and a relay is four movers with three changeovers, which is topic 1.2 with a baton in it. Football Day is topic 1.4 played for real. Multi-sports Day is a test of **range**, which is 1.1 again.

Two things a project manager should confirm before this page prints. The years supplied were **2026 for all three** term days, which would place the March and June days nine months *before* the December one. The book prints **2027** for terms 2 and 3, on the reading that this is the 2026/27 school year. If it is 2025/26, the December date is the one to change instead, and it is one line in `02-FRONT-MATTER.md`. And **water pong** is printed as the school named it; the name comes from an adult drinking game, so a school may prefer *target toss* or *bean bag into cups* on a Year 4 page.

Timing

Four topics and a project fill about six lessons of 45 minutes, which matches the Input, where each of the four objectives carries 89 minutes.

Topic 1.1 is the one to give extra time, and the part to protect is **task 4**, the re-check of three stations the pupil already had. It takes two minutes and it is the only evidence in the unit that consolidation happened rather than substitution. It is also the first thing a rushed lesson drops.

Assessment

Assess from the *Look what I can do* list and from step 5 of the project, not from the times. Two specific traps:

- A pupil who is quick and hesitates three times has **not** met 1.3. A pupil who is slow, even and hesitates never has.

- A pupil whose sequence is beautiful once has met 1.2 only if it is also repeatable. Ask for it twice, back to back, every time.

The Input names three assessment points across the year, one per term. Those become three review spreads in the complete book and are not part of this unit.

Adaptations

- **Distances, heights and timings are all adjustable.** The objective is control, not size. Shorten the lane, lower the hurdle, allow a longer run-up, widen the crossing.
- **A pupil who cannot travel** takes the same four families into a seated or supported movement: an arm pathway can be fast, slow, high, low, large, small, strong or light exactly as a run can, and a seated pupil can hold a balance, throw, catch and turn. The round of eight adapts station by station.
- **A pupil who cannot write** dictates the watcher's description to a partner, or draws the field instead. The description matters; the handwriting does not.
- **The crossing tasks need space.** If the hall is small, run one crossing at a time with the other groups still, rather than reducing the gap between routes.
- **Apparatus is set out and tested by an adult**, always. The green *Stay safe* panel in 1.4 is written to the pupil, but the responsibility is the teacher's.

Two notes on how this book is built

- **The Welcome is the pupil introduction** required by 15-IMPRINT-AND-HOUSE-STYLE.md sec 3. It sits after the contents, because BOOK-ANATOMY.md puts the contents fourth. The two rules disagree by one page; this title follows the anatomy, as Year 3 did.
- **This edition carries Unit 1 only.** Units 2 to 6 are mapped in 06-SCHEME-MAP.md and not written. This is a review sample, not a candidate for READY, and the shared checks are told so.